INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Marketing

RETAIL MERCHANDISING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the importance of merchandising to retailers.
2. Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.
3. Describe marketing functions and related activities.
4. Explain the concept of product mix.
5. Describe word-of-mouth channels used to communicate with targeted audiences.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the assistant manager at SIDELINE SPORTS, an independent sporting goods store in a mid-sized suburb. The store owner (judge) wants you to plan a new pickleball section that will bring new customers into the store.

SIDELINE SPORTS sells equipment and apparel for baseball, soccer, basketball and running. Pickleball is now one of the fastest-growing sports in the country, and the town just opened eight new public courts two miles from the store. Local players currently buy paddles, balls and shoes online or at a big-box store 25 minutes away. Many of the players are adults over 50, but more teens and young families are picking up the sport each month.

The store owner (judge) has cleared a 400-square-foot area near the front entrance for the new section. The store owner (judge) wants you to:

- Recommend the products the pickleball section should carry
- Explain how to merchandise the section so it encourages sales
- Explain how to spread the word to local pickleball players

You will present your ideas to the store owner (judge) in a role-play to take place in the store owner's (judge's) office. The store owner (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and have answered the store owner's (judge's) questions, the store owner (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What would make a pickleball player buy here instead of online?
2. Besides selling products, what other marketing activities will this launch require?
3.

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the importance of merchandising to retailers.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Describe marketing functions and related activities.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Explain the concept of product mix.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Describe word-of-mouth channels used to communicate with targeted audiences.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	